



Joe Soucheray

There are these old guys, old sportsmen, who sit on the faded, rock-back chairs in the sun at Hiawatha Golf Course and they are full of beautiful talk and memories. A lot of these guys have cheated death three or four times, so the sunshine, a chair on the veranda of a clubhouse and somebody to talk to is a big item.

Old ballplayers, some of them, like Spencer Harris, the guy in the checkered slacks and red golf shirt. He played nine holes the other morning and shot a 49, which is good considering the heart attack he suffered two years ago that put him in the hospital for the winter and reduced him to 107 pounds. When he played for the

Millers for 10 summers beginning in 1928, he was called Slug or The Duke because he performed at 145 pounds and hit home runs at the rate of about 30 a year.

"Baseball was a vacation with pay," Spencer Harris was saying on the eve of the modern ballplayer's All-Star Game. "And if I had it to do over again, I would. I graduated from Broadway High School in Seattle on a Friday and reported to Tacoma the next day. I got a walk my first time up. My first hit was a home run."

Spencer Harris was born in Duluth in 1900 to a railroad family. He spent his first years in Minnesota, his grade school days in Milwau-

kee and finished high school in Seattle. By the time he arrived back in Minneapolis to play for Mike Kelly's Millers, he had been up for two seasons with the White Sox and would go up twice more, in 1929 to Washington for a cup of coffee and in 1930 to Philadelphia for 22 games. He played most of his career in the minor leagues, but he would have been an all-star by today's standards.

"Halsey Hall and his cronies called Harris one of the best players they ever saw," said Bob Nordstrom, the pro at Hiawatha and the man to whom Harris has entrusted his scrapbook. "I remember him from

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